

LEAD OPPONENT SCOUTING REPORT

Opponent: Penn State

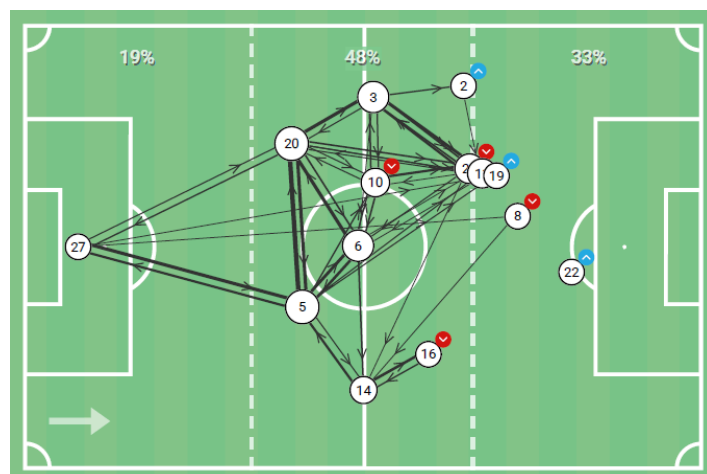
Date of Match: 10/25

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Opponent Record: 5-6-3 in Fall 2025 (most recently 1-2 loss against Washington)

Overall Team Overview (over conference games):

Penn State plays with a balanced approach, averaging 45.26% possession, and typically builds through their back line and central passing combinations. Their attack-minded central midfielders (#6 and #10) often act as ball carriers, progressing play or overloading advanced areas. Most of their open-play goals come from deliveries into the box, with high numbers crowding space to create chances. Set pieces, often taken by #11 or #3, are a key scoring avenue, frequently targeting #20, #10, and #8. Defensively, captain #20 stands out leading the team with 107 ball possession recoveries, a capable ball carrier in transition, and a consistent near-post target on set pieces. However, Penn State's backline has recently conceded goals from crosses, corners, and deliveries into the box from both flanks. Left back #3 also leads the team with 102 ball possession losses. Their attack-oriented style can leave them exposed in defensive transitions, particularly outnumbered centrally (only one holding CM) or in wide areas (2v1 situations against them).



Passing matrix vs Northwestern

PPDA	9.1	Moderate to aggressive press, looking to shape opponent play.
Average Possession %	45.26	Preference to progress through central passing patterns (left-side heavy).
Passes per Possession	3.39	Balanced approach with short and medium passes through open channels.
Shots/crosses per 90	11/15	Generates fewer shots/crosses than opponents (comparable #s to MSU).
xG per 90	1.40	Shot accuracy varies by opponent but maintains a high xG threat.

In Possession:

- Shape: 4-4-2
- During buildup, strong links between back line and CMs (#6, #10); GK moderately involved
- Mids are offensive minded, will combine centrally and create wide overloads to unbalance + finish

Out of Possession:

- Shape: 4-4-2 with mid to high block
- Moderate press (PPDA ~9.1); looking to limit opponent play and force errors
- Struggles with defensive transitions with low numbers back; concedes from deliveries and corners

Key Players:

- #11 – Caden Grabfelder (RM)
 - Leads the team in assists and key passes
 - Great shooter on the ball
- #19 – Kai Phillip (ST)
 - 2 goals on the season (1 header)
 - Athletic, fast player on the ball